alignment that makes it very likely that State C will offer strong support in a crisis.

Art has voiced reservations about a narrow definition of balancing and, in a debate with Brooks and Wohlforth, he suggested the following definition of balancing:

> behaviour designed to create a better range of outcomes for a state vis-àvis another state or coalition of states by adding to the power assets at its disposal, in an attempt to offset or diminish the advantages enjoyed by that other state or coalition. These assets include military forces, economic power and leverage, formal alliances, informal alignments, and voting and veto power in international organizations.

Art observed that use of any of the first three hard assets is hard balancing, while use of the last two would be soft balancing.[39] He furthermore argued that a balance between opposing forces need not be achieved for balancing behaviour to be taking place and that the intention/desire to balance should not be conflated with the result, which is a more balanced distribution of power.[40] According to Art,

> if one state upgrades its military capability to be better able to deal with another state's military capability and the threats it poses, that is hard balancing regardless of when it started, what provoked it, or whether it is intended to knock that power off its global superpower perch or not.[41]

Art's wider definition of balancing is useful to identify emerging trends, while we find the narrower definition of hard balancing presented previously useful for analysing and understanding more current circumstances. Exploring India's response to China's rise, we will apply the wider definition of